MIL-C-35088C
29 September 1978
SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-35088B
31 December 1969

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CHEESE, MOZZARELLA AND PROVOLONE, NATURAL

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers natural Italian-style cheese for use by the Armed Forces as an item of general issue (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification. The product shall be of the following types, classes and sizes as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Mozzarella

Class 1 - Regular.
Class 2 - Part skim (see 3.5.1.2).
Class 3 - Low moisture (see 3.5.1.3).
Class 4 - Low moisture - part skim (see 3.5.1.4).

Type II - Provolone

Class 1 - Smoked.
Class 2 - Not smoked.

Size (type I only):

1 - 5 to 10 pounds (2.27 to 4.54 kg).
2 - 10 to 15 pounds (4.54 to 6.80 kg).
3 - 15 through 20 pounds (6.80 through 9.07 kg).

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: US Army Natick Research and Development Command, ATTN: DRDNA-ES, Natick, MA 01760, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8910

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2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

L-P-378	-	Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin
UU-P-31	-	Paper, General Specifications and Methods of Testing
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-B-1163	-	Box, Corrugated Fiberboard, High Compression Strength, Weather-Resistant, Wax-Resin Impregnated

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-791	-	Lubricants, Liquid Fuels and Related Products, Method of Testing

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-1162	-	Sanitary Standards for Cheese and Cheese Products Plants

(Copies of specifications, standards, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

LAWS AND REGULATIONS

US DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE

Brucellosis Eradication - Recommended Uniform Methods and Rules, APHIS 91-1

Bovine Tuberculosis Eradication

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Information Division, APHIS, US Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

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Dairy Plants Surveyed and Approved for USDA Grading Service

Directory of Consumer Protection Programs Establishments, Circuits and Officials

Grading and Inspection, General Specifications for Approved Plants and Standards for Grades of Dairy Products - 7 CFR 58

(Application for copies may be addressed to the Information Division, FSQS, US Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

US DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH, EDUCATION AND WELFARE

Definitions and Standards of Identity for Cheeses and Related Cheese Products

Definitions and Standards of Identity for Mozzarella Cheese

Definitions and Standards of Identity for Provolone Cheese

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, US Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

AMERICAN PUBLIC HEALTH ASSOCIATION

Standard Methods for the Examination of Dairy Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Public Health Association, 1015 18th Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, P.O. Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington, DC 20044.)

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NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.

3.1.1 Milk. Raw milk shall be obtained from cows in herds accredited as tuberculosis-free and certified brucellosis-free by the US Department of Agriculture, or herds that have passed an annual tuberculosis test and meet USDA requirements for an individually certified herd, or from cows in herds located in:

(1) A modified accredited tuberculosis area; and
Either (a) A certified brucellosis-free area; or
(b) Modified certified brucellosis area; or

(2) An area in the process of being accredited in accordance with Uniform Methods and Rules - Bovine Tuberculosis Eradication and being certified in accordance with Brucellosis Eradication - Recommended Uniform Methods and Rules, APHIS 91-1, by the USDA

The raw milk at the time of use shall comply with requirements of Quality Specifications for Raw Milk by the USDA in Grading and Inspection, General Specifications for Approved Plants and Standards for Grades of Dairy Products - 7 CFR 58. The milk may be standardized for fat or solids not fat by centrifugal separation or by adding one or more of the following: cream, skimmed milk, concentrated skimmed milk, concentrated whole milk, nonfat dry milk, derived from milk meeting the aforementioned referenced requirements, and water in a quantity sufficient to reconstitute any concentrated skimmed milk, concentrated whole milk or nonfat dry milk used.

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3.1.2 Salt. Salt shall be crystalline sodium chloride of food grade quality.

3.1.3 Coloring. Coloring, if used in type II, shall be artificial blue or green color certified by US Food and Drug Administration.

3.1.4 Acidulants and milk coagulating enzymes. Acidifying or milk coagulating enzymes, if used, shall be those permitted by the Definitions and Standards of Identity for Mozzarella and Provolone Cheese.

3.1.5 Antimycotic agents. Antimycotic agents, if used, shall be safe and suitable as permitted by the Definitions and Standards of Identity for Mozzarella and Provolone Cheese.

3.2 Preparation. The preparation of these products shall meet the requirements as specified in the Definitions and Standards of Identity for Cheeses and related Cheese Products under the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. Type I product shall be made only from pasteurized milk. Type II product may be made either from pasteurized or unpasteurized milk (see 3.3).

3.3 Curing period (type II product only). Type II cheese, when made from unpasteurized milk, shall be held at a temperature of not less than 35°F (2°C) for not less than 60 days after manufacture.

3.4 Handling and storage temperature. Following preparation of the cheese as specified in 3.2 and immediately following packing as specified in 5.2, the boxes packed with type I or type II product shall be refrigerated at a temperature of from 35° to 40°F (2° to 4°C) (see 6.1 note).

3.5 Finished product. The products shall be free from earthy, musty, rancid, bitter, oxidized, tallowy, excessive acid or any other objectionable flavors and odors, except that type II may exhibit a slightly rancid or "piquant" flavor and odor. There shall be no visible signs of mold on the exterior or interior of the cheeses. Type I cheese shall possess a characteristic mild, bland flavor, and a soft, pliable body and texture (room temperature) and when melted, it shall be of a stringy, plastic consistency. Type II, class 1, cheese shall possess a characteristic slight pungent, mellow, smoked flavor and a smooth, plastic body and texture, except that after aging in excess of 6 months, the body and texture of the finished product may become slightly crumbly but it shall remain compact when sliced. Type II, class 2, cheese shall possess the same characteristics as class 1, except that it shall be free from a smoked flavor (see 6.1). In addition, the cheese shall comply with the analytical requirements in 3.5.1, 3.5.2, and 3.5.3, as applicable.

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3.5.1 Type I.

3.5.1.1 Class 1. The product shall contain more than 52 percent but not more than 60 percent moisture, and its milk fat content, on a solids basis, shall be not less than 45 percent.

3.5.1.2 Class 2. The product shall contain more than 52 percent but not more than 60 percent moisture, and its milk fat content, on a solids basis, shall be less than 45 percent but not less than 30 percent.

3.5.1.3 Class 3. The product shall contain more than 45 percent but not more than 52 percent moisture, and the milk fat content, calculated on the solids basis, shall be not less than 45 percent.

3.5.1.4 Class 4. The product shall contain more than 45 percent but not more than 52 percent moisture, and the milk fat content, calculated on the solids basis, shall be less than 45 percent but not less than 30 percent.

3.5.2 Type II.

3.5.2.1 Classes 1 and 2. The products shall contain not more than 45 percent moisture, and its milk fat content, on a solids basis, shall be not less than 45 percent.

3.5.3 Phosphatase activity. Types I and II products (except type II product when made from unpasteurized milk) shall meet the following phosphatase requirements:

The product shall be unacceptable if the phosphatase activity equals or exceeds one microgram of phenol per ml of cheese extract (equals 0.25 grams of cheese). Type II, class 1 shall be tested for phosphatase prior to smoking.

3.6 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared, processed and packaged under modern sanitary conditions and in accordance with good commercial practice in establishments listed in the US Department of Agriculture Publication entitled: Dairy Plants Surveyed and Approved for USDA Grading Service or in establishments meeting the requirements of MIL-STD-1162.

3.7 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Plant qualification conditions. The product furnished under this document shall be unacceptable if produced and stored in plants which do not currently meet the qualification conditions of 3.6.

4.3 Quality conformance inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.4 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.4.1 Inspection of milk and milk products.

4.4.1.1 Source of milk and milk products.

4.4.1.1.1 Animal sources. Inspection shall be made to determine that cows supplying the milk used in the preparation of this product are in herds designated by the U.S. Department of Agriculture as tuberculosis-free and from herds designated brucellosis-free or in the process of being so designated. Determination of herd status regarding tuberculosis and brucellosis shall be made by contacting the nearest Office of the Agricultural Research Service of the Animal Health Division. (Location of this office can be ascertained by consulting the publication entitled "Directory of Consumer Protection Programs Establishments, Circuits, and Officials"). Nonconformance to either of the above requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

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4.4.1.1.2 Component sources. Examination shall be made to determine that all milk and milk products used in the manufacture of the end items shall be received from establishments approved as military sources as listed in the "Directory of Sanitarily Approved Food Establishments for Armed Forces Procurement," or from plants listed by the US Department of Agriculture in the document entitled "Dairy Plants Surveyed and Approved for USDA Grading Service", and approved for the specific product shipped.

4.4.1.2 Examination of raw milk. The raw milk shall be examined and tested at the approximate time of use in the processing plant to determine compliance with the referenced requirements of 3.1.1 for acceptable milk. Records of all required examinations and tests shall be maintained and made available for review. Failure to comply with one or more of the specified requirements, reflected by actual examination and tests or by examination of records, shall be cause for rejection of the involved lot of finished product.

4.4.1.3 Examination of cream, skimmed milk, concentrated skimmed or whole milk and nonfat dry milk. Examination of these components shall be made to determine compliance with the requirements of 3.1.1 as concerns source and identity. Such compliance shall be ascertained by examination of plant records or other valid documents. Failure to comply with one or more of the above referenced requirements, reflected by actual examination or by examination of records shall be cause for rejection of the involved lot of finished product.

4.4.1.4 Examination of optional ingredients. Salt, coloring, acidifying and milk coagulating enzymes, and antimycotic agents shall be examined to determine compliance with 3.1.2 through 3.1.5 as concerns the identity by examination of invoices, labels or other valid documents. Nonconformance to one or more identity or condition requirements shall indicate an unacceptable ingredient and the use of such shall be cause for rejection of the involved end item.

4.4.1.5 Testing of components. Testing of components described in this specification shall be as shown in table I. Results shall be applicable to the lot average. Nonconformance to one or more test requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

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TABLE I. Testing of components 1/

Component	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	Inspection level	Characteristic	Results reported to	Test ref. and requt para.
Rubber hydrochloride base plastic wrapper	3 sq. yards (3 m^2)	Yards (meters)	S-1	Gauge	Nearest whole number	5.1.1.1 4.5.2
Copolymer of vinylidene chloride wrapper	3 sq. yards (3 m^2)	Yards (meters)	S-1	Thickness	Nearest 0.0001 inch 2/ (0.001 mm)	5.1.1.1 4.5.2
Heat shrinkable polyethylene	3 sq. yards (3 m^2)	Yards (meters)	S-1	Thickness inch 2/	Nearest 0.0001 inch (0.001 mm)	5.1.1.1 4.5.2
Wax paper	3 sq. yards (3 m^2) or equivalent in liners	Rolls or liners	S-1	Basis wt. of paper	Nearest lb/ream (g/m^2)	5.2.1.1.2
				Wt. of wax	Nearest lb/ream (g/m^2)	5.2.1.1.2
				Melting point	Nearest degree F (°C)	5.2.1.1.2
				Bursting strength	Nearest point	5.2.1.1.2
				Tearing resistance	Nearest gram	5.2.1.1.2

1/ Each component or component characteristic, as applicable, which is not listed in this table, unless otherwise excepted, shall be tested in accordance with the applicable procedure contained in pertinent subsidiary specifications.

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2/ In lieu of performing tests for thickness, conformance to requirements may be ascertained by examination of labels, invoices or other valid documents.

4.4.2 In-process examination. Examination shall be performed during processing to ascertain conformance to the standardization procedure of 3.1.1, when applicable, to the preparation requirements referenced in 3.2, and to the curing requirements of 3.3 as concerns temperature and curing time. Records of dates of manufacture, holding temperature and other applicable control data shall be maintained. Nonconformance to one or more specified requirements as ascertained by actual examination or reflected by records shall be cause for rejection of the involved quantity of finished product.

4.4.3 Examination of end item. Classification of defects found during examination shall be in accordance with tables III through V, and 4.4.3.1 through 4.4.3.2.3. The inspection levels, sample units, expression of lot sizes and acceptable quality levels (AQL) for the above referenced tables shall be as shown in table II. AQLs shall be expressed in terms of defects per hundred units for tables III and V and as percent defective for table IV.

TABLE II. End item examination criteria

Table	Inspection level	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	AQLs		
				Major A	Major B	Minor
III	S-3	One bagged, waxed or paraffined cheese	Bagged, waxed or paraffined cheeses	0.25	1.0	4.0
IV	S-3	One bagged, waxed or paraffined cheese	Bagged, waxed or paraffined cheeses	---	---	2.5
V	S-3	One bagged, waxed or paraffined cheese	Bagged, waxed or paraffined cheeses	1/	1.5	---

1/ The presence of a Major A defect shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

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TABLE III. External examination of packaging

Category			Defect
Major A	Major B	Minor	
101			Paraffin or wax coating or bag missing, or does not fully protect the surface of the cheese (as applicable).
	151		Not specified material.
		201	Not clean.
	152		Nomenclature missing, incorrect or illegible.
		202	Bag or wrapper does not conform closely to the cheese or is not practically free from wrinkles or wax or paraffin coating not of uniform thickness, or does not adhere tightly (as applicable).

TABLE IV. Examination for size 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	Net weight more than 1 pound (0.45 kg) under the lower limit or over the upper limit of the size specified.

1/ Report weight to the nearest 1/4 ounce (10 g).

2/ In determination of net weight when product is delivered in the intact package (bandage material) in which cured, such packaging (bandage material) will be considered as part of the net weight.

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TABLE V. Examination of product characteristics 1/

Category		Defect
Major A	Major B	
101		Presence of foreign material, such as wood, metal, glass, filth, insects or insect fragments.
	151	Not type or class specified.
	152	Presence of earthy, musty, rancid, bitter, oxidized, tallowy, excessive acid or other objectionable flavor or odors. 2/
	153	Presence of mold on the exterior or interior of the cheese. 3/
		TYPE I CHEESE ONLY
	154	Does not possess characteristic mild and bland flavor at room temperature.
	155	Does not possess characteristic soft, pliable body and texture at room temperature.
	156	Does not possess stringy, plastic consistency when melted. 4/
		TYPE II CHEESE ONLY
	157	Does not possess characteristic slightly pungent, mellow smoked flavor. 5/
	158	Does not possess smooth, plastic body and texture. 6/
	159	Class 2 product not free from smoked flavor.

1/ A standard trier plug of cheese shall be drawn from each cheese in the appropriate manner and examined organoleptically at room temperature.

2/ Type II product may contain a slight rancid or "piquant" flavor and odor.

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3/ The entire surface of the cheese shall be examined for visible signs of mold without removal of the plastic bag, paraffin or wax coating.

4/ Approximately 1/2 of a standard trier shall be examined for this defect.

5/ Not applicable to class 2 cheese.

6/ If aged in excess of 6 months, the body and texture may be slightly crumbly, but shall remain compact when sliced.

4.4.3.1 Examination for handling and storage temperatures. Determination of conformance to requirements of 3.4 as concerns temperature shall be ascertained by examination of records or by actual examination. Temperature records shall be maintained. Nonconformance to the above requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.4.3.2 Examination of shipping containers.

4.4.3.2.1 For level B pack. Examination of filled and closed shipping containers shall be in accordance with the examination criteria contained in the appendix to PPP-B-636 or PPP-B-1163. The following defects shall be included in the table of examination:

Major defects

1. National stock number, item description, contract number or date of pack, markings; missing, incorrect or illegible.
2. Liner or wrapper missing.

Minor defects

1. Other required markings or labeling missing, incorrect or illegible.
2. More than 60 pounds of product (as indicated by marked net weight).
3. Not lined or wrapped as specified.
4. Liner not cut as specified.
5. Insufficient wax on surface of liner or wrapper. 1/
6. Reinforcing bands do not contrast with black.

1/ Presence of wax on the fingernail when scraped lightly across the liner or wrapper shall be considered to be sufficient.

4.4.3.2.2 For level C pack. The filled and closed shipping container shall be examined for compliance with 5.2.2. In addition, there shall be a major defect as follows: NSN, item description, contract number, date of pack, markings: missing, incorrect or illegible.

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4.4.3.2.3 Examination of shipping container for marked net weight. The sample unit shall be one filled shipping container. Lot size shall be expressed in terms of the sample unit. Sample size shall be the number of sample units indicated by inspection level S-4. The lot shall be rejected if the sample average net weight is determined to be less than the sample average marked net weight.

4.4.4 Sampling procedure and acceptance criteria for testing of finished product. As specified in 3.5.1 through 3.5.3, the finished product shall be tested for milk fat, moisture and phosphatase as applicable. Procedures for testing shall be in accordance with 4.5. The sample for testing shall be an approximate 8 ounce (227 g) composite of standard trier plugs of cheese 2 inches (51 mm) in length, derived from the number of primary packages indicated by inspection level S-2. Lot size shall be expressed in terms of pounds (kilograms). Test results shall be reported to the nearest percent for milk fat and moisture, and as pass or fail for phosphatase. Lot shall be rejected if test results indicate nonconformance to one or more test requirements.

4.5 Test procedures.

4.5.1 Chemical analyses. Chemical analyses, when required, shall be made in accordance with the following methods for Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Dairy Products, Section: Cheese:

Test	Method
Milk fat	Fat - Official
Moisture	Moisture (vacuum oven)

4.5.1.1 Phosphatase. Phosphatase shall be determined by the Scharer Rapid Phosphatase Test as detailed in Standard Methods for the Examination of Dairy Products, Chapter: Phosphatase Methods to Determine Pasteurization.

4.5.2 Thickness of wrapper. Thickness of the wrapper specified in 5.1.1.1 shall be determined in accordance with L-P-378.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. The product shall be preserved in accordance with level B or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level B. In determination of net weight when product is delivered in the intact unit pack (bandage material) in which cured, such unit packs (bandage material) will not be considered part of the tare weight.

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5.1.1.1 For type I product. Five through 20 pounds (2.27 through 9.07 kg) of type I product in the size specified (see 1.2 and 6.2) shall be unit packed in a bag which shall cling closely to the cheese as a result of shrinkage, vacuumizing, or mechanical means, or a combination of one or more of these methods. The wrapper shall be one of the following:

1. A special frozen-food rubber hydrochloride-base plastic not less than 0.001-inch (0.025 mm) thick.
2. A copolymer of vinylidene chloride not less than 0.001-inch (0.025 mm) thick.
3. Heat shrinkable polyethylene not less than 0.001-inch (0.025 mm) thick; the thickness shall be tested in accordance with L-P-378.

The bag shall conform closely to the cheese, be unbroken, and it shall fully protect the surface.

5.1.1.2 For type II product. Ten through 13 pounds (4.54 through 5.9 kg) of type II product shall be unit packed in accordance with 5.1.1.1 or dipped in refined paraffin, amorphous wax, microcrystalline wax, or any combination of these. Such coating shall be a continuous, unbroken and uniform film adhering tightly to the entire surface of the cheese.

5.1.2 Level C. The product shall be preserved and packaged to afford adequate protection against deterioration and damage during shipment from the supply source to the first consuming activity. The contractor may use his standard practice when it meets these requirements.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level B or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level B packing.

5.2.1.1 Fiberboard box. Not more than 60 pounds (27 kg) of the product shall be packed into a snug-fitting fiberboard box constructed in accordance with style RSC, V3c, V3s or V4s of PPP-B-636. The box shall be lined with waxed paper as specified in 5.2.1.1.1, or each cheese shall be wrapped in waxed paper as specified in 5.2.1.1.2. In determination of net weight when product is delivered in the intact unit pack, bandage material will not be considered part of the tare weight. Alternatively, the shipping container shall be a wax-impregnated fiberboard box constructed in accordance with style RSC, class I, type SWCFI, grade 275, of PPP-B-1163. The wax-impregnated box shall be closed with hot-melt adhesive and shall be reinforced with two lengthwise bands and one girthwise band in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. All shipping containers shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. The reinforcing bands shall be uncolored or of a color which will contrast with black.

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5.2.1.1.1 Waxed paper liners. The interior surface of the container shall be completely lined with two sheets of waxed paper as specified in 5.2.1.1.2, so placed as to separate the packages from the top, bottom, sides, and ends of the container. The sheet shall be cut at least 2 inches (51 mm) wider and longer than the surfaces to be protected, and shall have an overlap of at least 4 inches (102 mm) wide along the center of the top of the shipping container. One sheet shall be positioned over the top, sides and bottom, and the other over the top, ends, and bottom. Alternatively, in place of using two sheets, a die-cut, one-piece liner may be used.

5.2.1.1.2 Waxed paper. The waxed paper shall be bleached, semi-bleached, or unbleached, kraft, sulphite, or vegetable parchment, having a minimum basis weight of 26 pounds per ream (24 by 36 - 500) (42 g/m^2) before waxing. Basis weight of paper shall be determined in accordance with Method 110 of UU-P-31. The paper (or vegetable parchment) shall be wet-waxed on both sides with a total of not less than 9 pounds per ream (15 g/m^2) of a fully refined paraffin having a melting point of not less than 125°F (52°C) as determined by Method 1402 of FED-STD-791. The quantity of wax on the surface shall be sufficient to show the presence of wax on the fingernail when it has been scraped lightly across the sheet. The waxed sheets shall have a bursting strength of not less than 22 points, when tested in accordance with Method 112 of UU-P-31, and a tearing resistance of not less than 18 grams, when tested in accordance with Method 170 of UU-P-31.

5.2.1.2 Alternate shipping containers. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC, W5c or W5s, of PPP-B-636. Alternatively, the shipping container shall be a wax-impregnated fiberboard box constructed in accordance with style RSC, class I, type SWCFI, grade 200, of PPP-B-1163. The wax-impregnated box shall be closed with hot-melt adhesive and shall be reinforced with two lengthwise bands and one girthwise band in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. All shipping containers shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. The reinforcing bands shall be uncolored or of a color which will contrast with black.

5.2.2 Level C packing. The product shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable, except that the closure of fiberboard boxes shall be in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

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5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Unit containers. Commercial labeling meeting the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder will be acceptable.

5.3.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129, and as specified in 5.3.2.1.

5.3.2.1 Additional marking. The following information, as applicable, shall be printed or legibly stenciled in letters not less than 1-inch (25 mm) high on top of the shipping container (applicable to level B shipment only):

PERISHABLE - KEEP REFRIGERATED (35° to 40°F) (2° to 4°C)

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The cheese covered by this specification is intended primarily for use in cooking, such as in the preparation of pizza pie and other specialty dishes, when a mild flavored, plastic and stringy-texture curd (when melted) is desired. Mozzarella cheese is made especially for this purpose. Provolone is a general-purpose type cheese. Freshly made, not smoked, or very lightly smoked provolone may be used in above mentioned dishes; and when aged and smoked, having a slight pungent, mellow, smoked flavor, and firm body (slices without crumbling), it is intended for table use, served sliced or in tidbit form.

NOTE: Type I cheese is normally marketed as a fresh product having an approximate shelf life of 30 days when held at a temperature of approximately 35°F (2°C). When frozen, its storage life can be prolonged although the product may show some deleterious effects in body and texture. If the freezing is too slow, the large ice crystals disrupt the structure of the cheese. At time of use, the frozen cheese should be thawed gradually under refrigeration 40° to 45°F (4° to 7°C) until a cheese temperature of 40° to 45°F (4° to 7°C) is reached and surface frosting is removed. This gradual thawing will minimize breakdown in the body and texture of the cheese. Type II cheese is also normally marketed as a fresh product and should be stored under refrigeration. Freezing is not recommended due to possible breakdown in body resulting in poor slicing characteristics. Its storage life when handled at temperatures in the range of 35° to 40°F (2° to 4°C) should be 6 months. When handled under no temperature control, its shelf life is reduced to as much as 90 days or less. The most common defect occurring when product is not held under refrigeration is the growth of a surface mold on the cheese; however, this mold does not make the cheese unacceptable for use.

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6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type and class of product required (see 1.2).
(c) Size of product required to type I (see 1.2).
(d) Levels of preservation and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(e) When packing specified in 5.2.1.2 is required.

6.3 Use of level B packaging. Level B packaging is intended to provide an economical but limited protection and should be specified only when it is determined that the product packaging provides protection against damage during multiple shipments in which shipping and handling will be under cover, and storage will be in warehouses or other structures providing equivalent protection from weather.

6.4 Plant sanitary conditions. Award of contracts for the product specified in this document will be limited to plants known to maintain the required sanitation conditions of 3.6 (see also 4.2).

6.5 Appropriate level of pack. Based on conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.14D/DSAR 4145.7.

6.6 Metric equivalents. Metric equivalents, indicated in parentheses throughout this document, are based on practices, conversion factors, and symbols specified in ASTM E 380 Standard for Metric Practice, and are for information only. In each instance, the value stated in US customary units shall be controlling.

6.7 Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue, due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8910-0405

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MC, MS
DLA - SS

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NATICK, MASSACHUSETTS 01760
OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300
DRDNA-ES

POSTAGE AND FEES PAID
DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY
DOD-314



Commander
US Army Natick Research and Development Command
ATTN: DRDNA-ES
Natick, MA 01760

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER *(Number)* AND TITLE

MIL-C-35088C Cheese, Mozzarella And Provolone, Natural

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS OF SUBMITTER

☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER

1. ☐ HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE? ☐ IS ANY PART OF IT TOO RIGID, RESTRICTIVE, LOOSE OR AMBIGUOUS? PLEASE EXPLAIN BELOW.

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING

B. RECOMMENDED WORDING CHANGE

C. REASON FOR RECOMMENDED CHANGE(S)

2. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address — Optional)*

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